

will then point to the newer version. Don't worry about having the developer tools installed; there are some useful tools in there, including the Git version control system discussed in Appendix D.

Python 2 on Older Versions of macOS

On older versions of macOS, before Monterey (macOS 12), an outdated version of Python 2 was installed by default. On these systems, the command `python` points to the outdated system interpreter. If you're using a version of macOS with Python 2 installed, make sure you use the **`python3`** command, and you'll always be using the version of Python you installed.

Python on Linux

Python is included by default on almost every Linux system. However, if the default version on your system is earlier than Python 3.9, you should install the latest version. You can also install the latest version if you want the most recent features, like Python's improved error messages. The following instructions should work for most apt-based systems.

Using the Default Python Installation

If you want to use the version of Python that `python3` points to, make sure you have these three additional packages installed:

```
$ sudo apt install python3-dev python3-pip python3-venv
```

These packages include tools that are useful for developers and tools that let you install third-party packages, like the ones used in the projects section of this book.

Installing the Latest Version of Python

We'll use a package called `deadsnakes`, which makes it easy to install multiple versions of Python. Enter the following commands:

```
$ sudo add-apt-repository ppa:deadsnakes/ppa
$ sudo apt update
$ sudo apt install python3.11
```

These commands will install Python 3.11 onto your system.

Enter the following command to start a terminal session that runs Python 3.11:

```
$ python3.11
>>>
```

Anywhere you see the command `python` in this book, use **`python3.11`** instead. You'll also want to use this command when you run programs from the terminal.